

Technology News



VirtualBox 2.2 supports OVF and virtual appliances

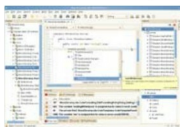
Sun Microsystems has announced the availability of Sun VirtualBox 2.2, which introduces support for the new Open Virtualization Format (OVF) standard, along with significant performance enhancements and updates. VirtualBox 2.2 software enables users to build virtual machines or appliances and effortlessly export them from a development environment, and import them into a production environment. Support for OVF also helps to ensure VirtualBox 2.2 software is interoperable with other technologies that follow the standard.



Additional features of VirtualBox 2.2 software include Hypervisor optimisations, 3D graphics acceleration for Linux and Solaris applications using OpenGL, and a new host-interface networking mode, which makes it easier to run server applications in virtual machines. To download the freely available Sun VirtualBox software, visit: <http://www.sun.com/software/products/virtualbox/get.jsp>.

Better ASP.NET with MonoDevelop 2.0, Mono 2.4

MonoDevelop 2.0 has been released with the aim of enabling developers to write desktop and ASP.NET Web applications on Linux. port .NET applications created with Microsoft Visual Studio to Linux and Mac OS X, and maintain a single code base for all three platforms. MonoDevelop provides tools to simplify and



streamline .NET application development on Linux, including: improved ASP.NET and C# 3.0 support and a built-in debugger. It now uses MSBuild-style project files to increase interoperability with Visual Studio. Web projects are now also compatible with Visual Studio 2008 and Visual Web Developer 2008 SP1, providing more options for developers who want to build and deploy their Web applications on both Windows and Linux.

New features available in Mono 2.4 include a new code generation engine that improves the performance of executing .NET applications on the Mono runtime, while managed Single Instruction, Multiple Data (SIMD) extensions enable developers to take advantage of hardware acceleration without having to program in lower-level languages. Additional runtime innovations, such as full ahead-of-time (AOT) compilation, bring Mono-based applications to new platforms, including the Apple iPhone. MonoDevelop 2.0 and Mono 2.4 are available now and can be downloaded at www.mono-project.com/downloads.

New Embedded InnoDB

Innodb has introduced its newest product, Embedded InnoDB. Made for application developers, device makers and ISVs, Embedded InnoDB claims to provide all the high-performance, proven and reliable data management features of InnoDB for embedding in target applications—all with a small footprint, low overhead and no unnecessary features. It is designed to be linked directly into application programs, and provides highly efficient, low-level database management services, without using SQL. Embedded InnoDB is currently available in binary form for Linux and Windows, and in source form under the GPL V2 licence.

The Android 1.5 early-look SDK is out!

To give developers a headstart, the next release of the Android 1.5 early-look SDK has now been made available. The Android 1.5 platform will include many improvements and new features for users and developers. Additionally, the SDK itself introduces several new capabilities that enable you to develop applications more efficiently for multiple platform versions and locales. The new SDK has a different component structure compared to earlier SDK releases. This means that it does not work with older Eclipse plug-ins (ADT 0.8) and the old SDKs (1.1 and earlier) do not work with this new Eclipse plug-in (ADT 0.9).



Note that since this is an early-look SDK, the tools and documentation are not complete. Additionally, the API reference documentation for it is provided only in the downloadable SDK package—see the documentation in the SDK's docs/reference/ directory. Visit developer.android.com/sdk/preview/features.html to get a grip over the feature set of the Android 1.5 SDK.

CentOS-5.3 for i386 and x86-64

Based on the upstream release of RHEL 5.3, CentOS 5.3 has finally been released and introduces a completely new artwork stack. The contrib repository is also now back. The release notes for CentOS-5.3 can be found on-line at wiki.centos.org/Manuals/ReleaseNotes/CentOS5.3.